

DAT Feedback 2025

[no data for weeks 9, 10, 11 due to timing of survey]

Favourite Topics

4]PDFs [17] Interesting to see! I also liked this topic, which is why I spent a whole week on it. I will definitely keep that in future.

6] Stats [14] Also interesting to see! I might flesh this out even more in future.

8]Estimators [8] This does not surprise me, estimators are awesome.

1] Probability [4] These earlier topics- less interesting? less recent? or a bit of both?

3] Functions [4]

2] Data, RVs [3]

5] Uncertainties, correlations [3] You three are mad!

7]Tools [2] Poor old Monte Carlo languishing in last place! To be fair though, week 7 is the hardest week for many people in terms of exhaustion.

Conclusion: students prefer even-numbered weeks' material 😊

Favourite Workshops

Week 4] PDFs [9]

Week 2] Probability & Data [8]

Week 7] Estimators [8]

Week 6] Stats [8]

Week 3] Functions [7]

Week 8] Math Helpers and MLE [6]

Week 5] Uncertainties, correlations [5]

Conclusion: there is very little spread here, which is nice for me to see because I spent a ton of time on all of them 😊

WHAT YOU LIKED

Python [21]

Mixing theory with practice / linking math to coding [12]

Variety in coursework [5]

Math [3]

Links with other modules [2]

Abundance of plots and examples , visual aids, resources page, latex. Individual topics mentioned were Bayes/Probability, CLT, Monte Carlo.

Conclusion: python! Again, I am delighted by this, given the time I put into prepping those materials on a hunch that you would feel this way.

WHAT YOU WOULD CHANGE

Issues mentioned multiple times that I found very valuable

Pace was too fast for the such high-level math topics [13]

Merge into a single 2H lecture [10]

More workshop time [8]

Cannot focus in the 5pm lecture [7]

Content of first weeks was too basic [5]

More real world connections/context would be helpful [4]

More optional practice questions with solutions would be helpful [3]

More individual support, in-class activities and student-led process [3]

Conclusion: I agree with all of these comments.

Single-mention comments that I found very valuable

Lots of cross-over with other modules in terms of foundational material.

This is very valuable information, thank you! I am reaching out to the other people developing content for the students who have DAT as an option, with the aim of trying to harmonise our offerings to some extent.

It would help to have a textbook for help with some topics

Yes. The Barlow textbook officially associated with this module is a little old fashioned. I will find out what book others recommend, and what is available in the library.

Step-by-step guidance early on (python), first workshop should be on marimo, more explanations on the code examples

Yes. I totally agree that the first workshop should include hands on help with installation etcetera, and will ask for a week 1 workshop in future. I also agree that more is more when it comes to python comments and instructions, and will work on that.

Was all the theory really necessary? (Lily)

More depth to Monte Carlo, include statistical manifolds, fisher metric, multivariable distributions. Less dice rolling!

I think there is a whole module on MC next term that many of you are signed up to, so I hope that covers everything. I am sorry for those who are not doing this module.

There are professors here at Sussex who specialise in statistical manifolds- Fernando Rosas, Adam Barret. They can probably point you to some resources.

Less dice rolling - sorry 😊 the warning is in the module image!

Practical matters: Some PDF problem sets rotated, Zoom did not always work - access code.

Thanks, these things should be easy to fix in future, although I have no idea what went wrong with the zoom password, as i changed nothing, so that might not permanently solulable...